The Brothers Grimm Spectaculathon

By Don Zolidis

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles: ***Actor:*** *Narrator 2, Dirt Merchant, Enchantress, The Devil, Prince, Witch, Actor, Stepsister 1 and 2*
Actress: *Narrator 1, Girl, Rapunzel, Dwarf 1 and 2, Snow White. Mirror, Cinderella, Herald, Prince Charming*

NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 307-308)** Hello and welcome to the Brothers Grimm Spectaculathon!

NARRATOR 2: *(Exploding onto the stage)* Sunday Sunday Sunday! It's EXTREME! See! Monster slaying action as the three-headed pig battles the wolfo-bot in a bone-crushing cage match of death. They'll huff and they'll puff, and they'll kick some iron! Aaaaaaahh!

NARRATOR 1: Okay, stop. We're not doing that. **NARRATOR 2:** Flames! Flames!

NARRATOR 1: Enough, ***[actor's name].*** You're weirding them out.

NARRATOR 2: I'm EXTREME.

NARRATOR 1: No you're not. Can we just do the show?

NARRATOR 2: *(pouts then assumes a more reserved demeanor)*The Brothers Grimm were brothers named Grimm. They are dead. But in the period before they died the Brothers Grimm wrote 209 fairy tales

NARRATOR 1: These stories have become extremely popular. We all know them today.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR: *So . . . (looks at an imaginary pocket watch) I don't have time today to present all 209 stories. (sad face) – But I do have time for Rapunzel!*
ACTRESS: *(Sings: Ah, ah, ah, ah, ah, ah, ah, ah)*
ACTOR: *Snow White* ***ACTRESS:*** *(Mirror Mirror on the wall . . .)*
ACTOR: *and Cinderella* ***ACTRESS:*** *(Bippity, boppity boo!)*
ACTOR: *Hold onto your seats . . .*
ACTRESS: *This is going to be one wild ride!*
TOGETHER: *The Brothers Grimm Spectaculathon by Don Zolidis*

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NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 309-310)** So . . . Once upon a time there was a girl

NARRATOR 2: And she was beautiful-

NARRATOR 1: Because no one cares about ugly people.

NARRATOR 2: I care about ugly people.

NARRATOR 1: Well no one cares about you. Anyway, there was a girl . . . *(GIRL enters in dramatic fashion.)*

NARRATOR 2: And she was poor.

GIRL: Oh I am poor.

NARRATOR 2: Dirt poor.

NARRATOR 1: She couldn't even afford dirt. *(DIRT MERCHANT enters.)*

DIRT MERCHANT: Dirt for sale! Dirt for sale! Hey, you! Get off the merchandise! *(He exits.)*

GIRL: *(Crying) (An ENCHANTRESS enters.)*

ENCHANTRESS: Excuse me-but I couldn't help overhearing your tale of misery and woe. Tell you what-I will grant you your heart's desire if you give me one small thing.

GIRL: That sounds like a great bargain. I won't even ask what the small thing is because I'm so innocent and trusting!

ENCHANTRESS: Excellent. *(She makes a magical signal and vanishes)*

GIRL: What a nice lady. *(THE DEVIL enters.)*

THE DEVIL: Hey there hot stuff. Oh wait, that's me. Ha ha ha ha! Now, I happened to overhear your tale of misery and woe and I'm here to help.

GIRL: Well actually I just-

THE DEVIL: Just sign this one small contract and you shall conceive a daughter so beautiful the very earth will want to kiss her. But in a platonic way.

GIRL: That sounds like a great idea. *(She signs the contract.)*

THE DEVIL: Moo ah ha ha ha ha ha! *(He looks around. Then runs off)*

NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 311-** It was a good day for the girl. She fell in love with a prince.

PRINCE: *(PRINCE enters.)* Hey, you're hot!

GIRL: I am hot.

PRINCE: Let's get married!

GIRL: Score!

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NARRATOR 2: She grew very rich.

GIRL: Ha ha! Score!

NARRATOR 2: And she conceived a child.

GIRL: Whoah! How did that happen?

NARRATOR 2: Well, you see kids, when a prince and a princess love each other very much-

NARRATOR 1: Through magic. The magic of The Devil. That's where babies come from!

NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 312-313)** Years passed. And she grew into a beautiful young teenager, Rapunzel.

GIRL: Darling, we're going to have dinner so wash your hands.

RAPUNZEL: You can't tell me what to do!

PRINCE: Don't talk to your mother that way. She sold her soul to the Devil just to have you-

RAPUNZEL: I don't care! I didn't ask to be born!

NARRATOR 1: And just then.

ENCHANTRESS: I have returned.

THE DEVIL: Your time is up.

GIRL: What do you want?

ENCHANTRESS: *(as they fight over Rapunzel)* Your child.

THE DEVIL: Your child.

RAPUNZEL: STOP!! Mom!? How many deals did you make?

ENCHANTRESS: **(Pg 314)** I will take Rapunzel. *(She grabs RAPUNZEL)*

THE DEVIL: Um ... excuse me? I'm The Devil *(He grabs RAPUNZEL.)* Lord of darkness? All that? I think I've got a little bit more claim to this girl than some stupid little witch.

ENCHANTRESS: I curse you!

THE DEVIL: I curse you right back! You know what, this is stupid. Tell ya what, if you sign this contract here, I will let you take Rapunzel.

ENCHANTRESS: That sounds like a plan. *(She signs the contract.)*

THE DEVIL: Moo ah ha ha ha! And I disappear in a cloud of brimstone!

ENCHANTRESS: Well, come along Rapunzel.

RAPUNZEL: Where are we going?

ENCHANTRESS: I built this great tower for you.

GIRL: Run along dear.

RAPUNZEL: But Mom. I don't want to go with the evil Enchantress

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GIRL: Yeah and I didn't want to raise a spoiled brat. But sometimes you don't always get what you want. Unless you make a deal with The Devil. See ya.

NARRATOR 2: So the Enchantress took Rapunzel and locked her in a high tower without stairs or door.

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NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 320-321)** Once upon a time. There was a dwarf.

DWARF 1: I prefer little person.

NARRATOR 1: In fact, two dwarves. And these dwarves worked all day in the mines.

DWARF 2: *(Singing)* Whistle while you work

NARRATOR 1: We can't use that song.

DWARF 2: I do what I want.

NARRATOR 1: No it's like copyrighted, we can't use it. The Mouse will sue us. So the dwarves worked in the mines, they sang their little song and then one day they came home to find- *(Enter SNOW WHITE. She falls asleep.)*

DWARF 1: What the heck is that thing? *(menacingly)* I'm going to chop you up and eat you.

NARRATOR 1: Time out. Time out.

DWARF 1: What? I'm just going with what my character wants.

NARRATOR 1: You do not get to eat Snow White. You're not the villain of the story. We are going to do this story as written. Snow White cleans house for the dwarves, then she gets poisoned by an apple, then a prince shows up-

SNOW WHITE: *(Waking up)* Why do I have to clean the house? Is it because I'm a woman?

DWARF 1: Yes.

NARRATOR 1: No it's because you feel sorry for the little dwarves because they're messy and you have OCD and want to make everything nice.

SNOW WHITE: I don't see why I have to be a maid! I'm the princess here, they should be cleaning up for me.

DWARF 1: All right, she's become too much trouble, let's eat her.

NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 323)** And moving on.

SNOW WHITE: **(Pg 309)** Once upon a time there was a beautiful girl. **(Pg 323)** She was the most beautiful girl in the entire kingdom. But her stepmother was jealous. *(WITCH enters)*

WITCH: Snow White.

SNOW WHITE: Stepmother.

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WITCH: I do believe you're putting on weight.

SNOW WHITE: Not on this body, sister. These curves are tight and streamlined

WITCH: I think you might need to tweeze your eyebrows.

SNOW WHITE: My eyebrows are sculpted like a block of clay in the hands of a blind god of sculpting eyebrows. . . . *(looks concerned)* Who writes this stuff? *(Snow exits)*

WITCH: Mirror, mirror, on the wall. Who's the fairest of them all

MIRROR: *(A drawn-out ghostly voice)* Well it's certainly not you.

WITCH: Curses!

MIRROR: Hey that's a good idea. You should try that

WITCH: **(Pg 324)** Snow White.

SNOW WHITE: Stepmother.

WITCH: How about an apple as a peace offering?

SNOW WHITE: When are you going to learn Stepmother, that we women shouldn't be judged by our surface beauty but rather by the contents of our brains?

WITCH: Um ... that's just stupid.

PRINCE: Hey I was just in the neighborhood looking for a girl in a coma to make out with *(Snow White grabs PRINCE and bends him over backward for a kiss)* Whoah! You're very forward.

SNOW WHITE: I'm a modern woman. Come on, let's get married.

NARRATOR 2: And they all lived happily ever after and avoided traditional gender roles. And the seven little dwarves cooked for them, cleaned the house, and did all that other junk that Snow White was supposed to do in the story. The end.

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NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 309)** Once upon a time. **(Pg 330)** [Cinderella's] mother died and her father remarried.

CINDERELLA: **(Pg 329)** *(enters, overacting)* I am orphaned! Oh I am sad!

ACTOR: **(Pg 330-332)** *(An ACTOR enter.)* Hold on! We [can't] do this one

NARRATOR 2: Well, I guess we can skip it then.

CINDERELLA: *(CINDERELLA stops acting)* NO WE ARE NOT SKIPPING IT. We are going to tell my story, OR I WILL TEAR OUT YOUR TINY HEART, GOT IT?

ACTOR: Yes, Ma'am.

CINDERELLA: Thank you.

NARRATOR 2: Okay, so, her mother died and her father remarried

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CINDERELLA: *(Overlapping)* Mother? Where are you mother? Are you dead?

NARRATOR 2: Now, Cinderella's stepmother had two daughters, both equally beautiful-

CINDERELLA: *(CINDERELLA raises her hand)* I'm sorry. I think you've got that wrong. I'm the pretty one. They're quite hideous.

NARRATOR 2: Says here they're beautiful too.

CINDERELLA: I think I know my story, thank you. Oh they are so mean . . . so mean.

STEPSISTER 1: *(The two WICKED STEPSISTERS enter)* Look what the cat dragged in.

STEPSISTER 2: Does it smell in here, or is it just her?

STEPSISTER 1: Oh Cinderella. I need to get ready for the ball

CINDERELLA: What ball?

STEPSISTER 1: The ball being thrown by Prince Charming.

STEPSISTER 2: He's so charming. When I see him I just want to grab his little tights-wearing bottom

CINDERELLA: Can I come?

STEPSISTER 1: Of course you can ... NOT! I'm so hot.

STEPSISTER 2: I'm gorgeous. *(Stepsisters exit)*

CINDERELLA: *(Overacting)* Life. So unfair. The room is spinning. Why, God, why? Why am I just a servant - a slave! Lower than the dust. I shall now cry myself to sleep as I do every night. *(She cries)*

NARRATOR 2: *(To the audience)* She thinks the Oscar committee is watching.

CINDERELLA: **(Pg 333)** How can life be so cruel! WHY?!!!! *(She hears a sound)* What's that? My fairy godmother?

NARRATOR 2: Nope. We're going by the original. There's no fairy godmother.

CINDERELLA: Well, I can't do this without a fairy godmother. Who's going to turn the pumpkin into a coach?

NARRATOR 2: You walk there.

CINDERELLA: What?! I'm Cinderella! *(She stomps off)*

NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 335)** Just then Cinderella's two wicked stepsisters arrive [at the ball]

STEPSISTER 1: Cinderella! What are you doing here?

STEPSISTER 2: You suck!

HERALD: **(Pg 336-338)** *(Blowing imaginary horn)* Dun de dun dun! His royal highness, the Prince! *(The*

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stepsisters go wild)

PRINCE CHARMING: *(with a British accent for no apparent reason)* 'Ello there. We're having a nice time, are we? Blimey. She's gorgeous. Who's that minx?

CINDERELLA: My name's Cinderella.

PRINCE CHARMING: Right-o. Come here and give us a taste, love. *(PRINCE CHARMING and CINDERELLA begin to dance – He is REALLY bad)*

CINDERELLA: Oh Prince. Stop. You're embarrassing me.

NARRATOR 2: And they danced all night long. *(Stepsister wail and stomp off)*

CINDERELLA: What are these feelings? Could it be . . . love? *(Clock begins to strike, Cinderella panics and runs off, losing her shoe in the process, the prince picks it up, has an idea and exits)*

ACTOR: Can we skip to that part please?

NARRATOR 2: You know what? Fine. A little of this, a little of that, the prince stops by with a shoe looking for a girl who fits it.

PRINCE CHARMING: 'Ello then. Any of you darlings lost a shoe?

STEPSISTER 1: Oh I did. I did! Let me see that! *(She takes the shoe.)*

NARRATOR 2: And of course, her foot was too big, so she chopped off her big toe.

STEPSISTER 1: *(Blood-curdling scream)* Aarrrrrrrrr- rrrrrrrrrgghghgghghg! *(She limps)* It . . . fits . . .

PRINCE CHARMING: Say, what's all this then? There's blood everywhere. *(He wrestles the shoe off her foot)*

STEPSISTER 1: I popped a zit. On my foot.

PRINCE CHARMING: You chopped off your toe, you did!

STEPSISTER 2: May I please try the shoe. *(Prince shrugs and hand over the shoe)*

NARRATOR 2: The shoe didn't fit either. So she did the only sensible thing and chopped off her heel. *(Blood-curdling scream)*

STEPSISTER 2: Arrghgghghffhfhgh! I'm . . . fine! *(She limps* See. . .it fits.

PRINCE CHARMING: Is that blood on your foot?

STEPSISTER 2: I cut myself shaving. I have hairy feet. Like a hobbit.

PRINCE CHARMING: You cut off your heel you daft wench!

STEPSISTER 2: I did it for you! *(Prince takes the show from Stepsister 2)*

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PRINCE CHARMING: 'Ello there. I realize several of the ladies in this here house have chopped off body parts to fit in this here shoe, but I was just wondering if anyone else fit in it. You see, I'm not very smart, but I make up for it by being very persistent. It makes me ideal to run the government. *(CINDERELLA runs to him.)*

CINDERELLA: I will try the shoe.

PRINCE CHARMING: It fits!

CINDERELLA: My love!

PRINCE CHARMING: It is you!

CINDERELLA: It is I!

NARRATOR 2: And they lived. Happily. Ever. After.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2009 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
2012 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2014 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier
2017 National Qualifier
2019 National Qualifier
2020 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier
2023 National Qualifier – MS
2024 National Qualifier
2024 National Qualifier – MS
CO State Qualifier
KS State Qualifier
MN State Qualifier
OH State Qualifier

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